Business Knowledge Brief: © Agora Insights Ltd

By Deirdre Caren

Legend
Pink: To be completed by the business and supported by BA
Orange: To be complete by the BA and requires business support
Blue: To be led by the BA and supported by the project team and business

What has happened

1. Background

What is the context of this need? Who is affected, when are they affected, when did you notice this, Whom do you need to work with to produce and deliver your solution?

2. Problem/Opportunity

What do you need to have in order to produce, market and deliver your solution? Why does this matter to you?

What problem do you solve and how do you solve it?

4. Root Cause Analysis

How you have determined what is the actual problem (not just the symptoms or solution)

3: Critical Success Factors

What are the costs that have occurred in terms of
Time
- *Resources*
- *Money*
- *Reputation*
- *Revenue*
- *Waste*

By fixing this problem, what savings/benefits (as listed above) do you think will be achieved and at what scale? (ie we will eliminate duplicate process waste and finish the job 2x faster)
Describe the elements that are necessary for the project's success.
For example:
- *Increased invoice processing by 25%.*
- *Reduction of non-production time spent at a team level by 15%.*
- *Decreased operational reporting errors by 30%.*

What should happen

5: Stakeholders

Who needs your solution?
How many people need your solution right now?

How many people will eventually need your solution?
Who will support the change
Who will pay for it?
What does the customer need?
What is the RASCI?

6: Current State

How do you deliver to customers today?What are the actual steps (not the steps that you hope are being followed) even if there isn't a documented process, it can still be drawn up

This part of the document is typically followed with a process map (ie customer journey map, BPMN, Flowchart etc) The purpose is to ensure we understand what is happening today so that we know what bits to be fixed/changed

This box provides a summary and associate links to the models

8: Future State

How do you deliver to customers in the future? Include the integrations required like systems, policies etc as listed in your high level requirements. Red pen important areas

This part of the document is typically followed with a process map (ie customer journey map, BPMN, Flowchart etc) The purpose is to ensure we understand how to structure the future state and the change

This box should provide a summary and associate links to the models

7: Business Requirements

Complete all or necessary business requirements with appropriate measures and priority

1. *People (such as 20 staff require training by {date})*
2. *Process*
3. *Technology*
4. *Data*
5. *Regulations*
6. *Customers*
7. *External factors*
8. *Security*
9. *Vendors/Suppliers*
10. *Reporting*
11. *Financial*
12. *Transition (things that have to be available during the change process)*
13. *Communication needs, internal and external*

9: Financial Estimation

What are the best options to move forward considering the financial state?

Present using a ROM or Pert chart

10: Recommendations

What do you, as a business analyst feel would be the best way to approach this and why. You can suggest multiple options if they are appropriate

11: Next Steps

What would be the direct next steps to come out of this Knowledge Brief? These could be things like create user requirements, obtain approval, pause, review, sign off etc

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12: Other/Out of Scope

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What is the context of this need? Who is affected, when are they affected, when did you notice this, Whom do you need to work with to produce and deliver your solution?

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- *Waste*

By fixing this problem, what savings/benefits (as listed above) do you think will be achieved and at what scale? (ie we will eliminate duplicate process waste and finish the job 2x faster)
Describe the elements that are necessary for the project's success. For example:

- *Increased invoice processing by 25%.*
- *Reduction of non-production time spent at a team level by 15%.*
- *Decreased operational reporting errors by 30%.*
- *Increase in service response times for client inquiries by 20%.*

4: Root Cause

How you have determined what is the actual problem (not just the symptoms or solution)

5: Stakeholders

Who needs your solution?
How many people need your solution right now?

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7: Business Requirements

Complete all or necessary high level business requirements with appropriate measures and priority

1. *People (such as 20 staff require training by {date})*
2. *Process*
3. *Technology*
4. *Data*
5. *Regulations*
6. *Customers*
7. *External factors*
8. *Security*
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How do you deliver to customers in the future? Include the integrations required like systems, policies etc as listed in your high level requirements. Red pen important areas

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